Website Update Guide

Rick J Berube Art Studio

How to update your website, send changes to GitHub, and put them on the live site

What	Where
Live website	https://rjbart.netlify.app
Preview on your computer	http://localhost:5180 (admin page: /admin)
Project folder	C:\Users\rberu\Documents\rjb-art-studio
GitHub backup	https://github.com/RickB54/RJB_Art_Studio
Netlify dashboard	https://app.netlify.com/projects/rjbart

How to use this guide: Read sections 1 and 2 once. Then keep section 7 (the routine) and the last page (the cheat sheet) open whenever you update the site. Menu names in Netlify and Google may change slightly over time. Updated October 2026.

1. The big picture

Your website lives in **three places**. Most confusion comes from mixing them up.

Place	What it is	Does it change the live site?
Your computer	The project folder. The preview (localhost:5180) and the admin page run here. Only you can see them.	No
GitHub	A backup and history of all your files. Think of it as a safe.	**No.** Sending files to GitHub does not update the website.
Netlify	The live website everyone sees at rjbart.netlify.app.	Only when you **deploy**

Golden rule: Edit on your computer, check it on localhost, then publish once. The live site only changes at the last step.

The flow

```
Edit (admin page)  ->  Preview (localhost:5180, only you)
   ->  GitHub (backup, does NOT change the live site)
   ->  Netlify deploy (THIS changes the live site)
```

Deploy vs. publish

Word	Meaning	Command
Build	Turns your project into the finished website files in a folder called dist. Also finds errors.	`npm run build`
Deploy	Builds the site and uploads it to Netlify so the world sees it. This is Netlify's word.	`npm run deploy`
Publish	Your project's shortcut. Runs safety checks, saves ALL files to GitHub, builds, then deploys: GitHub backup + deploy in one step.	`npm run publish`
Draft deploy	A test upload with a private preview link. Not live. Free.	`npx netlify deploy --dir=dist`
Production deploy	The real thing. Goes live. Costs 15 credits.	`npx netlify deploy --prod --dir=dist`

Two things to remember: (1) The admin page only edits files on your computer. Nothing you save there appears on the live website until you publish. (2) Only **you** publish. Every live deploy costs 15 of your 300 Netlify credits per billing cycle, so make all your changes first, then deploy once. If credits run out, the live site pauses.

2. Words you will see

Word	Plain-English meaning
Terminal	The text window where you type commands. In Antigravity or VS Code: Terminal, then New Terminal.
CLI	Command Line Interface: controlling a program by typing commands. The Netlify CLI lets you control Netlify from the terminal.
npm / npx	Tools that run your project's commands. `npm run dev` runs a project script. `npx` runs a tool without installing it.
localhost:5180	The preview of your site, running only on your computer. Stops when you close it or press Ctrl+C.
Git / Commit / Push	Git tracks every version of your files. A commit is a saved snapshot with a message. A push sends your commits to GitHub.
origin / main	origin = your GitHub repo. main = the main line of your project. `git push origin main` means send to GitHub.
dist	The folder with the finished, ready-to-upload website. Created by npm run build.
Block	A piece of content you add to a page in the admin: text, photo, cards, notice, button, embed or video.
Embed	Showing another website's content (like a Google Form) inside your page.
Responses	The tab in Google Forms where every submitted form appears.
Credits	Netlify's usage allowance. Production deploys cost credits. See section 8.
.env	A private file holding your YouTube API key. It must never go to GitHub.
Working tree clean	Git's way of saying all your changes are already saved in a commit.

3. Getting started each time

1. Open Antigravity (or VS Code) and open your project folder (File, then Open Folder, then rjb-art-studio).
2. Open a terminal: **Terminal, then New Terminal**. The path shown must end in **rjb-art-studio**. If it does not, type:

```
cd C:\Users\rberu\Documents\rjb-art-studio
```

3. Start the preview:

```
npm run dev
```

4. Open **http://localhost:5180** for the public site, or **http://localhost:5180/admin** for the admin page.

Handy terminal tips

Tip	What it does
Ctrl+C	Stops whatever is running (such as the preview). If it does not stop, the server is running in another window. Close that window, or use the stop command on the troubleshooting page.
Up arrow	Brings back the last command you typed.
+ button in the terminal bar	Opens a second terminal tab so the preview can keep running.
Click inside the terminal	Needed before arrow keys work in menus. There is no mouse cursor in those menus. Use arrow keys and Enter.
Red warnings about LF and CRLF	Harmless. They only mention line endings.

4. Using the admin page

Open **http://localhost:5180/admin** (it only works while npm run dev is running). Everything you save goes into files on your computer.

Tab	What it is for
Add Single Painting	Add one painting. Choose **From YouTube video** (paste a link, click Fetch) or **Photo only** (drag photos from your PC into the drop zone, or click to browse). Fill in title, category, size, status and price.
Bulk Importer	Paste many video links at once, one per line. Add a playlist name after a | to file it.
Paintings	Edit, delete or hide any painting. Set status (For Sale, Sold, Not Available, Reserved), price, Fine Art America link, and whether it shows on the Home page.
Playlists	Add a playlist by pasting its YouTube link. Sync pulls in new videos. Hide, reorder, or set a cover video.
Page Text & Content	Choose a page from the page menu, then edit its text, lists, photos and sections. See the next page.
? Help	Short how-to notes, and a copy of this guide.

Add a painting from your computer

1. Click **Add Single Painting**, then choose **Photo only**.
2. Drag one or more photos into the drop zone. Photos are shrunk automatically so they load fast.
3. Fill in the title, category, size, status and price. Click Save.
4. Check the Gallery at http://localhost:5180/gallery.

Editing page text and adding blocks

1. Click **Page Text & Content** and pick the page you want from the page menu (Home, Gallery, About, Commissions & Prints, Videos, Contact, Header & Footer).
2. Change any text box. Use the checkboxes at the top to show or hide whole sections.
3. Lists (cards, steps, awards, shows) have **Add**, up/down arrows and a trash can.
4. Click **Save Page Content Changes**. The page now shows **Saved**.
5. Open the page on localhost to check it. If you do not like a change, use **Restore Default Text**.

Add a block (new text, photo, button or video anywhere)

A block is a new piece of content you can add to a page without any code. Pick a type, click **Add Block**, fill it in and save.

Block type	Use it for
Text Section	A heading and paragraphs (for example, a new announcement).
Image + Text	A photo next to text, such as a photo of yourself on the About page. Use the drop zone to add the photo.
Cards Row	A row of small cards, such as a new service.
Notice Box	A highlighted message (for example, art show dates).
Button Link	A button that goes to any page or website.
Embed (Google Forms / URL)	Shows a Google Form or other web page inside your page.
Video (YouTube)	A YouTube video that plays on the page.

Remember: Blocks and text edits are saved on your computer. They go live only after you publish.

5. Your Google Forms

Your Contact and Commission forms are Google Forms. Google keeps the answers, and your website shows each form on its page. Nothing about the forms uses Netlify or costs credits.

Change which form a page shows

1. In Google Forms open the form, click **Send**, then the **<>** tab.
2. Copy only the address after **src=** (it starts with https://docs.google.com/forms/ and ends with embedded=true).
3. In the admin, open **Page Text & Content**, choose the Contact or Commissions page, paste the address in the form box, and Save.

Test a form

1. Open the form in Google Forms and go to **Responses**. Note the count.
2. Fill in the form on http://localhost:5180/contact with TEST - ignore and submit.
3. Reload Responses. The count should go up by one.
4. Turn on email alerts: Responses, three dots, **Get email notifications for new responses**. Check Gmail and spam.

> **If visitors cannot submit:** In the form's Settings, turn off **Collect email addresses**, **Limit to 1 response** and any sign-in requirement, and remove file-upload questions. These block outside visitors. Make sure Responses says **Accepting responses**.

Tip: Google Forms can add a painting's title to a form automatically using a **pre-filled link** (three dots, then **Get pre-filled link**). Ask Gemini to build that into the Inquire / Buy buttons if you want it.

6. Command reference

npm commands (project scripts)

Command	What it does	Live site?
`npm run dev`	Starts the preview on localhost:5180	No
`npm run build`	Builds into dist and finds errors. Run it before deploying.	No
`npm run check`	Runs the automatic checks (55 tests). Stop the preview first.	No
`node --env-file=.env scripts/sync-playlists.mjs`	Pulls your latest YouTube playlist videos (needs your API key in .env).	No
`npm run deploy`	Build, then upload to Netlify production	**Yes** (15 credits)
`npm run publish -- "message"`	Checks, GitHub (all files), build, deploy	**Yes** (15 credits)

Git commands (GitHub backup)

Command	What it does
`git status`	Shows what changed. 'working tree clean' means everything is saved.
`git add -A`	Selects all changed and new files (except those blocked by .gitignore).
`git commit -m "message"`	Saves a snapshot with a short message.
`git push origin main`	Sends the commits to GitHub.
`git log --oneline`	Lists past commits. Press q to leave the list.
`git check-ignore .env`	Should print .env. That proves Git will never upload your key.

Netlify CLI commands (type npx in front)

Command	What it does
`npx netlify status`	Shows which Netlify account and project you are connected to.
`npx netlify open`	Opens your project in the Netlify dashboard.
`npx netlify deploy --dir=dist`	**Draft** deploy: a test link that is not live. Free.
`npx netlify deploy --prod --dir=dist`	**Production** deploy: goes live. 15 credits.
`npx netlify login`	Signs in (use rjbartstudio@gmail.com). Answer y if it asks to install.
`npx netlify logout`	Signs out (use if it connected to the wrong account).

7. Step-by-step routines

Routine A: Add or edit content and go live

1. Open the terminal in your project folder and start the preview:

```
npm run dev
```

2. Open **http://localhost:5180/admin**. Add paintings, edit page text, add blocks, or click **Sync** on a playlist.
3. Check your work on http://localhost:5180 (Gallery, Videos, Commissions, Contact, footer).
4. Make **all** your changes first. Each live deploy costs 15 credits.
5. Stop the preview (Ctrl+C or close its terminal). Run the checks:

```
npm run build
npm run check
```

6. Publish once (this also backs up to GitHub):

```
npm run publish -- "what I changed"
```

7. Wait for **Publish complete!**. Then check https://rjbart.netlify.app in an **Incognito window**.
8. Add **/admin** to the live address. It must not show your admin screen.
9. Run **git status**. It should say the working tree is clean.

Routine B: Back up to GitHub only (no live change)

1. Check what changed, then select and save everything:

```
git status
git add -A
git commit -m "Describe what you changed"
```

2. Send it to GitHub. If a browser window opens, sign in as RickB54:

```
git push origin main
```

Routine C: Free test before going live

1. Build the site:

```
npm run build
```

2. Upload a draft (not live, no credits). Answer y if it asks to install:

```
npx netlify deploy --dir=dist
```

3. Open the Website draft URL it prints and look at the pages. Then publish with Routine A step 6.

Routine D: Check your Netlify credits

1. Open Netlify, select your team, then **Usage & billing**. It shows your remaining credits and when they reset.

About credits

Fact (check the dashboard for changes)	
Free plan allowance	300 credits per billing cycle. Unused credits do not roll over.
Production deploy	15 credits each, so about 20 per cycle.
Free to do	Draft deploys, failed deploys, rolling back, and form submissions.
Also uses credits	Visitor traffic (bandwidth) and requests. Your site is light because YouTube hosts your videos.
If credits run out	The live site pauses until the cycle resets. Keep enough for one emergency fix.

Never let an AI helper deploy for you. Tell Gemini or any AI helper: do not run npm run publish, npm run deploy or any netlify command. You publish yourself, once, when everything is finished.

8. When something goes wrong

What you see	What it means and what to do
fatal: 'original' does not appear to be a git repository	A typo. The GitHub address is named **origin**: `git push origin main`
Build failed with red errors	A file was left half-edited. **Do not deploy.** Find the last good commit with `git log --oneline`, then restore just that file: `git checkout abc1234 -- src/pages/Gallery.jsx` (use the real code in place of abc1234). Run `npm run build` again.
I pushed to GitHub but the website did not change	GitHub does not update Netlify. Run `npm run deploy` or `npm run publish`.
I saved in the admin but the live site looks the same	The admin only changes files on your computer. Publish to make it live.
Ctrl+C will not stop the preview	It is running in another window. Close that window, or in PowerShell run: `Get-NetTCPConnection -LocalPort 5180 -State Listen | ForEach-Object { Stop-Process -Id $_.OwningProcess -Force }`
Port 5180 is already in use	A preview is already running. Use that one, or stop it as above.
npm run check fails to start	The preview is still running on 5180. Stop it, then run the check again.
A thumbnail shows a broken image	The file name in the page data does not match the file in public/images. Open the broken image in a new tab to see the name it wants, then fix the name.
The Google Form does not appear	The embed address is missing or wrong. Copy it again from Send, then the <> tab (section 5).
The live site shows 'no access'	The project is private. In Netlify: Project configuration, General, Visitor access, set to Public.
Netlify says I am out of credits	Wait for the reset date on Usage & billing. Do not keep retrying.
Netlify CLI connected to the wrong account	`npx netlify logout` then `npx netlify login` in the Chrome profile for rjbartstudio@gmail.com.
Sync says my API key is missing	Run it this way: `node --env-file=.env scripts/sync-playlists.mjs`
Red LF / CRLF warnings	Harmless. Ignore them.

9. Safety rules

Never share your YouTube API key. Keep it only in the .env file. Do not paste it into chats, screenshots or other files. If it ever leaks, delete it in Google Cloud and make a new one.

Rule	Why
Run `git check-ignore .env` once in a while. It should print .env.	Proves your key is blocked from GitHub.
Never use `git add -f`.	It forces blocked files into GitHub.
Run `git status` before publishing.	Lets you see what is about to be saved.
Do not deploy if `npm run build` shows errors.	A broken build means the site will not update correctly.
Check /admin on the live site after deploying.	It must not show the admin screen. The admin is only for your computer.
Keep reference-old-site and old backups out of GitHub.	They contain private data and large files.
Batch your updates, and let only you deploy.	Each production deploy uses 15 of your 300 credits.
Keep contact details you do not want public (phone, home address) out of page text and PDFs.	Everything on the live site is public.

Cheat sheet: the routine in one page

Step	Do this	Command or place
1	Open the project and a terminal	Antigravity or VS Code: Terminal, New Terminal
2	Start the preview	`npm run dev`
3	Edit in the admin page, then Save	http://localhost:5180/admin
4	Check the public pages	http://localhost:5180
5	Stop the preview	Ctrl+C
6	Build and run the checks	`npm run build` then `npm run check`
7	Publish once (GitHub + live)	`npm run publish -- "message"`
8	Check the live site in Incognito	rjbart.netlify.app
9	Check /admin shows no admin screen	rjbart.netlify.app/admin
10	Check your credits now and then	Netlify, Usage & billing

Just back up (no live change)

```
git status
git add -A
git commit -m "your message"
git push origin main
```

Just test (free, not live)

```
npm run build
npx netlify deploy --dir=dist
```

Go live by hand

```
npm run build
npx netlify deploy --prod --dir=dist
```